

GRADUATE HANDBOOK

UNIVERSITY of VIRGINIA

DEPARTMENT of MATHEMATICS

2026-2027 ACADEMIC YEAR

DEPARTMENT STAFF

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Department Manager	Dallas Pitt	Dep7y	214
Senior Fiscal Tech	Matthew Basham	Jpr3pm	218
Intermediate Administrative Coordinator	Kaitlyn Miller	Fez8eg	216
Academic Operations Specialist	Malvika (Malu) Rajagopal	Geg7jw	Kerchof 218, (Tue, Fri) Halsey 103 (Mon, Wed, Thu)
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FACULTY

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Peter Abramenko	Pa8e@virginia.edu	Algebra
Julie Bergner	jeb2md@virginia.edu	Homotopy Theory, Algebraic Topology, Algebraic K-Theory
Yen Do	yqd3p@virginia.edu	Harmonic Analysis, Random Polynomials
Mikhail Ershov	ershov@virginia.edu	Algebra
Aseel Farhat	af7py@virginia.edu	PDE
Juraj Földes	jf8dc@virginia.edu	PDE, Probability, Applied Mathematics
Evangelia Gazaki	eg4va@virginia.edu	Arithmetic Geometry
Christian Gromoll	gromoll@virginia.edu	Probability
Benjamin Hayes	brh5c@virginia.edu	Functional Analysis, Operator Algebras
Peter Humphries	ph7ph@virginia.edu	Number Theory, Representation Theory
Thomas Koberda	tmk5a@virginia.edu	Geometric Group Theory

Slava Krushkal	krushkal@virginia.edu	Low-dimensional Geometry and Topology
Sara Maloni	sm4cw@virginia.edu	Low-Dimensional Topology, Hyperbolic Geometry
Thomas Mark	tmark@virginia.edu	Low-Dimensional Topology
Tai Melcher	melcher@virginia.edu	Probability
Jennifer Morse	jlm6cj@virginia.edu	Combinatorics
Ken Ono	ko5wk@virginia.edu	Number Theory
Leonid Petrov	petrov@virginia.edu	Probability and Combinatorics
You Qi	yq2dw@virginia.edu	Representation Theory, Categorification
J.D. Quigley	mbp6pj@virginia.edu	Homotopy Theory, Algebraic Topology, K-Theory
Andrei Rapinchuk	asr3x@virginia.edu	Algebraic Groups
Christian Reidys	cmr3hk@virginia.edu	Applied Mathematics
David Sherman	dsherman@virginia.edu	Operator Algebras
Weiqiang Wang	ww9c@virginia.edu	Representation Theory, Quantum Groups

GENERAL FACULTY

Name	Email address	Appointment / Field
Kristina Cernekova	kc5kv@virginia.edu	General Faculty Lecturer
Evangelos Dimou	ed8bg@virginia.edu	Assistant Professor, General Faculty
Jeffrey Holt	jeff@virginia.edu	Professor, General Faculty
Shuler Hopkins	vyr5zh@virginia.edu	Assistant Professor, General Faculty
Daniel James	hdj4nd@virginia.edu	Associate Professor, General Faculty; Applied Mathematics
Brianna Kurtz	nbm2vp@virginia.edu	Assistant Professor, General Faculty
Jim Rolf	jsr2pz@virginia.edu	Professor, General Faculty
Josh Turner	rbh3vx@virginia.edu	Assistant Professor, General Faculty
Caelan Wang	qgf6bc@virginia.edu	Assistant Professor, General Faculty

EMERGENCY CONTACTS

Department	Phone Number	Address
Police, Fire, Paramedics (Emergency)	911	
Uva Police	434-924-7166	104 Midmont Lane, Charlottesville
Safe Walk (w/ Ambassador)	434-984-7622, ext. 406	
Student Counseling & Psychological Services (CAPS)	434-243-5150	550 Brandon Ave Sth-caps@virginia.edu
Office of the Dean of Students	434-924-7133	Rotunda, Northeast Wing odos@virginia.edu
UVA Human Resources	434-243-3344	2420 Old Ivy Road AskHR@virginia.edu
International Students & Scholars Program (ISSP), International Studies Office	434-982-3010 (If you are calling from outside the US, add a +1 before dialing the number	208 Minor Hall issp@virginia.edu
Student Financial Services	434-982-5300	1001 Emmet St N sfs@virginia.edu

PHD GRADUATION DEADLINES

Spring	Feb 1: GSAS Graduation Application	April 30: Submit Final Exam Form, Complete Survey of Earned Doctorates, Submit Dissertation to Libra
Summer	July 1: GSAS Graduation Application	July 31: Submit Final Exam Form, Complete Survey of Earned Doctorates, Submit Dissertation to Libra
Fall	October 1: GSAS Graduation Application	November 30: Submit Final Exam Form, Complete Survey of Earned Doctorates, Submit Dissertation to Libra

https://graduate.as.virginia.edu/thesis-submission-and-graduation

MS GRADUATION DEADLINES

Submit the Degree Request form by Oct 1 (Fall) / Feb 1 (Spring) / Jul 1 (Summer). Submit the Final Exam Form by Nov 30 (Fall) / Apr 30 (Spring) / Jul 31 (Summer).

https://graduate.as.virginia.edu/thesis-submission-and-graduation

2026-2027 ACADEMIC CALENDAR

We have provided an academic calendar, which includes a number of activities and deadlines. While we will generally provide reminders throughout the year, the ultimate responsibility for your program rests with you. Please consult this guide, which will be periodically updated online, for the duration of your graduate experience.

Fall Term 2026

Fall Arrival & Welcome	August 20 – August 24
Courses begin	August 25
Labor Day (Academic Division Classes will be held)	September 7
Add/Drop/Withdrawal	Varies by school
Reading Days	October 3 - October 6
Election Day	November 3
Family Weekend	October 23 - October 25
Thanksgiving recess	November 25 – November 29
Courses end	December 8
Reading Days	December 13 & December 16
Examinations	December 10 - December 18
Fall degree conferral date (as it will appear on the academic record)	December 18 (no ceremony)

January Term 2027

Courses Begin	January 4

Courses End	January 15

Spring Term 2027

University Holiday (MLK Holiday)	January 18
Courses begin	January 20
Add/Drop/Withdrawal	Varies by school
Spring Recess	March 6 - March 14
Courses end	May 4
Examinations	May 6 - May 14
Reading Days	May 9 & May 12
Finals Weekend	May 21 - May 23

ADMISSION AND ORIENTATION

Admission to the graduate program (Phd and en-route Masters) is based on multiple factors. You can find information all the information here on our website:
https://math.virginia.edu/graduate/admission/

Main links:

- Graduate School of Arts & Sciences admissions page (includes "Apply")
- Direct link to UVA's application system — deadline for applications is January 15th.

Application Checklist:

1. Application;
2. Statement of purpose;
3. 2 or 3 letters of recommendation;
4. Unofficial transcript;
5. $85 application fee;
6. TOEFL, IELTS or Duolingo English Test (DET) score for international students, unless waived. See the Graduate School requirements. In exceptional circumstances, it might be possible to replace the test score with an in-person / video interview with UVA faculty.

Other useful links

- Application fee waiver information for U.S. citizens

- Graduate School requirements
  Under the Fees tab on this page, there is additional information about automatic application fee waivers for citizens of certain countries.
- Graduate School deadlines
- Graduate School frequently asked questions

Please note that the Department of Mathematics does not normally admit students seeking only a Masters degree; we are primarily a PhD program.

In making its decisions about admission and financial aid, the Department is first and foremost looking for students that we feel will flourish in our program. To determine if a student will be successful, the Department pays close attention to the overall undergraduate record, letters of recommendation, and the student's personal statement.
Regarding the undergraduate record, the rigor of the applicant's mathematics program is an important factor; a good grounding in real analysis (as in our MATH 4310 and MATH 4330), algebra (as in MATH 4651 and MATH 4652), general topology (as in MATH 4770), and complex analysis (as in MATH 3340) is ideal. Applicants may or may not choose to include unofficial GRE Mathematics Subject scores. Applications that do not include GRE Mathematics Subject scores will not be penalized in any way.

Research areas

Students occasionally arrive with an area of interest in mind, planning to work with a specific research group: this is quite common for international students. Foreign applicants are particularly encouraged to contact our faculty about their specific mathematical interests.

Finally, we are looking for enthusiasm for mathematics in all its depth and beauty!

International Students

As the University's most international department, we welcome applications from foreign students!

The following websites for international students should be helpful:

- General information for admitted international students: General information for admitted international students
- International Studies Office: International Studies Office

New teaching assistants whose first language is not English must take the oral section of the University of Virginia English Language Proficiency Exam (UVELPE), administered by the Center for American English Language and Culture (CAELC), even if they were exempt from the TOEFL/IELTS requirement at admission. There are no exemptions from the oral section. A score of 55 or higher, or successful completion of ESL 911, releases a student to teach.

Contact Information

Graduate School of Arts and Sciences

P. O. Box 401102
University of Virginia
Charlottesville, Virginia 22904
e-mail: gsasadmission@virginia.edu
Telephone (434) 243-0209

Admissions, Department of Mathematics

P. O. Box 400137
University of Virginia
Charlottesville, Virginia 22904-4137
e-mail: af7py@virginia.edu (Aseel Farhat)
Telephone: (434) 924-4918 (TDD: (434) 982-HEAR)

Academic Probation

Academic standing, probation, and required withdrawal are governed by the Graduate School of Arts & Sciences Academic Rules in the Graduate Record. For questions go to the Director of Graduate Studies.

Affiliated Status

An advanced doctoral or master's student who has fulfilled all school- and program-level degree requirements except for the dissertation or thesis may petition for Doctoral/Thesis Completion (Affiliated) Status by submitting the Doctoral/Thesis Completion form to the Director of Graduate Studies. This status is intended for students who only need to complete the writing of their dissertation or thesis and will not be engaging in research activities. Students on Affiliated Status are not required to register for credit during the semester of their defense and may defend while on this status. Doctoral/Thesis Completion in Affiliated Status does not constitute enrollment but provides continued NetBadge computer system privileges, including access to UVA email and electronic library resources. However, students do not retain an active student ID card, access to university facilities or student services (including Student Health), eligibility for graduate assistantships, or student loan deferment. Students with outstanding federal student loans will begin repayment once any applicable grace period has ended and should contact Student

Financial Services with questions regarding loan implications. International students should contact the International Studies Office before petitioning for this status to determine any impact on visa eligibility. Once approved, students are not eligible to return to full-time study in a degree program but may renew this status for up to four consecutive terms for doctoral students or two consecutive terms for master's students (summer terms do not count toward this total). A fee of $230 per term is charged for each term of enrollment in this status, and departments may be able to cover this cost; students should consult their advisor and Director of Graduate Studies regarding this possibility.

Course Withdrawal

A student who wishes to withdraw from a course after add/drop has closed may do so through the first eight weeks of the term using this **Course Withdrawal Request Form**. A grade of "W" will be recorded for this course on the student's transcript. Students may be required to add non-topical credits to remain enrolled full-time (for master's degree students this will result in added tuition charges), in which case the student must also submit **GSAS Course Action Form**.

TRAVEL REIMBURSEMENTS

Contact the business office (Matthew Basham, jpr3pm@virginia.edu ; Malvika Rajagopal, geg7jw@virginia.edu) to discuss.

For the business office to process reimbursements, we will need a) worktags for the account b) name of conference and location c) itemized receipts for everything (e.g., airfare, taxi, hotels, and meals; note: alcohol will not be reimbursed due to account restrictions). If traveling in a group please note that each person must pay for their own meal. If requesting mileage, the business office needs the address of the travel location. When traveling internationally, airlines should be a U.S. airline.

Check with your advisor to see which travel funds you are eligible for.

NOTE ON MEALS: If you ask for Per Diem please check with your research advisor to ensure that it will be covered. Students on Fellowships are not eligible for Per Diem.

NOTE ON CAR RENTALS: Extras will not be covered, with one exception: collision damage insurance (CDW/LDW). UVA-contracted vendors (Enterprise, Hertz, National) include it in the rate; if you rent from another vendor or overseas, purchase it.

Internal DGS funding

We have money to support graduate student travel to conferences, workshops, and other institutions for work-related visits. Apply for funding with the host institutions, but then also email math-dgs@virginia.edu with the proposed expenses before your trip.
The default standard purpose of the DGS funding is to support PhD students to participate in various workshops, conferences, and mathematical meetings which fit well with their research areas.

1. A request for funding with a specific amount and a short justification can be emailed to DGS.
2. The request is capped at $1000 per PhD student for the period of Academic Year 2026/27 + Summer 2027.
3. Only students who have passed both general exams are eligible.
4. The endorsement of the funding request by an advisor (or some potential advisor in case no formal advisor is declared yet) is required.
5. Co-sharing with partial support from workshops or conferences or advisor's grant is encouraged.
6. Research collaborations and giving presentations in conferences are encouraged.

Funding may sometimes be used by students for other purposes, such as poster presentations. Exceptions beyond the standard guidelines can be made, up to the approval by the DGS and the Graduate Committee.

Student Disability Access Center

The Student Disability Access Center (SDAC) is the University of Virginia's designated access agency for students with disabilities. They support UVA students in the work of creating access to the full University experience. Their primary role is to determine eligibility and to provide reasonable academic accommodations for students with disabilities in line with Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990, as amended. These federal laws ensure that institutions of higher learning provide equal access to students with disabilities who are "otherwise qualified" to meet the essential demands of the academic program.

The SDAC provides services to two groups of students: those who have been previously diagnosed with a disability; and those who have never been diagnosed, but find themselves struggling academically, and seek advice and support on their difficulties. For more information, see the link here: https://disabilityservices.studenthealth.virginia.edu/about

International Studies Office and ISSP

The International Studies Office (ISO) and its International Students & Scholars Program (ISSP) offer several programs for international students.

VISAS (Volunteers with International Students, Staff, & Scholars), a program of the Center for American English Language and Culture (CAELC), is a great program for students to not only improve language skills but also to meet other students through volunteer programs.

DEPARTMENT EVENTS AND ROOMS

Room Reservations in Kerchof

You can make the room reservations by going to the Kerchof room booking system on the Math website. Please create your own account to start making reservations. Logged-in users may create up to five non-recurring bookings. For rooms outside of Kerchof Hall or for any recurring booking, please contact math-help@virginia.edu.

Events with Department Visitors

The Department and the Institute of Mathematical Science (IMS) host distinguished visitors, including the Virginia Mathematics Lectures speakers. Their schedules are set by the organizers. Graduate students are encouraged to meet visitors. If you would like to organize an event with a visitor, such as a lunch, a pre-talk or a discussion, please contact the organizers of the visit before contacting the visitor or requesting department funds.

STUDENT FINANCIALS

Financial support, in the form of fellowships, traineeships, Research Assistantships (GRA) and Teaching Assistantships (GTA), is available to Ph.D. students as detailed below. If satisfactory progress is made, a Ph.D. candidate is assured support for five years by any combination of these support mechanisms. If there are significant mitigating circumstances, a student may apply for a longer period of support. Recommendations in such cases will be made by the Director of Graduate Studies, subject to approval by the Department Chair.

All students admitted into the Ph.D. program are assured financial support for five years of study, contingent on satisfactory progress in the program. Such support includes living support (in the form of teaching or research assistantship wages or fellowship stipends), plus full payment of tuition and academic fees and a single person health insurance premium

First year PhD students are typically assigned Teaching Assistantships and are assigned tasks by the DGS (for years 2-5) and by Dr. Brianna Kurtz (for first years). Your duties may include conducting one discussion class per week, grading assessments and/or homework assignments, holding regular office hours, and attending instructor meetings according to your supervisor's instructions. Additional duties may be assigned by your supervisor.

It is expected that the duties associated with this GTA appointment will require up to 15 hours per week, on average. The time required may fluctuate during the semester based on the course schedule. Note that the overall time required for your success as a graduate student, including

GTA duties as well as your own classes and research activities, may be the equivalent of at least full-time employment.

Please see your GTA letters for more details.

Payroll Schedule

If you have any questions about your pay, please contact Dallas Pitt dep7y@virginia.edu and Math-help@virginia.edu.

Information on wages, stipends and taxes can be found on: https://gradstudies.virginia.edu/funding-and-aid-faqs-graduate-students

Stipend

Stipend support is typically (although not always) provided in advance of the period that it is intended to support; thus a stipend payment intended to support a student for the month of September would typically be received by September 1. Regular stipend payments (those distributed over a semester or year) are disbursed monthly. For example, a one-year fellowship will typically be provided in the form of 12 monthly stipend payments, each disbursed in advance of the period they are intended to cover. One-time stipends intended to support the incremental costs of research or other professional development activities are typically provided in advance of the activities they are intended to support and may be disbursed at any time. Students should check with their school or department for specific information on how stipends are disbursed in their programs.

Wages

Wages are paid after the period of work in which they are earned. At UVA students earning wages are paid bi-weekly according to the Academic Biweekly payroll calendar published by UVA Finance: https://uvafinance.virginia.edu/payroll/academic-division.

Expense Reports

Graduate students are expected to file their own Expense Reports on Workday. Here is a link to the Quick Reference Guide to help you complete it: https://uvafinance.virginia.edu/sites/uvafinance/files/2022-07/UVAFST_QRG_CreateExpenseReportv2.pdf

You can reach out to the Department Manager – Dallas Pitt dep7y@virginia.edu or the Senior Fiscal Tech Matthew Basham: jpr3pm@virginia.edu to get the correct WorkTags.

I-9 Requirement for students who are Teaching Assistants

Federal law requires that prior to beginning work for the University all students (and other employees) must verify that they are authorized to work in the United States by completing an I-9 form. Unless this form is completed within 72 hours of the start of a student's first employment assignment at the University they will be unable to earn wages. There are no exceptions to the I-9 requirement.

In order to complete the I-9 process, students must present relevant documentation in person. UVA Human Resources maintains a website with information for students on the I-9 process, including dates and times for in-person documentation sessions taking place at various locations around Grounds. Please see the UVA HR website for more information: https://hr.virginia.edu/student-i-9-documentation.

DEGREE REQUIREMENTS

Course Requirements

Courses and research amounting to 72 credit hours. Courses must include satisfactory work in two semesters of analysis (MATH 7310, 7340), algebra (MATH 7751, 7752), and topology (MATH 7820, 7800), or the equivalent. Students may take approved courses from other departments. Students entering our program with a masters degree from another institution may get credit for up to 24 hours of coursework.

General Examinations

Passing grades on two General Examinations, chosen from Algebra, Analysis, and Topology. These written exams cover the following material: Algebra (MATH 7751, 7752), Analysis (MATH 7310, 7340), and Topology (MATH 7820, 7800). The Analysis exam is split into two parts: Complex and Real, which are taken and graded independently.

These exams are typically offered twice a year, January and August. A student may repeat the examinations as many times as needed in order to satisfy the following requirements:

Old policy (*applies to students who started their graduate program before August 2025*): Students are expected to attempt two different general examinations before the beginning of the third semester, to pass at least one general examination before the beginning of the fourth semester, and to pass both exams before the beginning of the sixth semester.

New policy (*adopted in April 2025, applies to students who started their graduate program in August 2025 or later*): Students are expected to attempt two different general examinations before the beginning of the third semester, to pass at least one general examination before the beginning of the fourth semester, and to pass both exams before the beginning of the fifth semester.

Syllabi for the Algebra, Analysis, and Topology General Examinations:

- Syllabus for Algebra General Exam • PDF
- Syllabus for Analysis General Exam • PDF
- Syllabus for Topology General Exam • PDF

Second-Year Proficiency Examination

The second-year proficiency examination is an oral examination that assesses whether a student is prepared to begin doing research in their chosen area with a thesis advisor. The oral exam is expected to be passed by the conclusion of the fourth semester and must be passed by the beginning of the sixth semester. The exam format is flexible and can be tailored to the students' and examiners' preferences. For example, it can consist of the student giving a presentation, followed by a question-and-answer period with the examiners, but it could also simply take the form of a question-and-answer exam. Typically, these exams should be expected to take 1.5-2 hours.

A student should develop an exam syllabus together with the intended thesis advisor and one additional permanent faculty member. The nature of the syllabus can be flexible, depending on the research area and preferences of the student and examiners. It could still take the form of a list of topics in a given area, drawn from a course or from standard textbooks, but could also take the form of a review of relevant papers, or a suitable combination. The quantity of material should be roughly comparable to the content of two second-year courses. While the exam format can be flexible, in the ways discussed above, it should be specified in the syllabus for approval.

The syllabus should be submitted to the Graduate Committee at least four weeks before the intended exam to allow for adequate time for review and revision, if necessary. After the exam, regardless of the outcome, a form should be submitted to the department, including signatures of the two faculty examiners, indicating which of the two is the intended advisor, as well as the Director of Graduate Studies, to confirm that the syllabus was approved by the Graduate Committee.

Students already enrolled in Fall 2022 or earlier, before this format was approved, may opt to take the oral exam in the previous format of two faculty examining a student on the material from two semester courses on material beyond the first-year courses.

Dissertation and Defense

The Ph.D. dissertation defense is a formal examination of a substantial body of completed research. To ensure that dissertation committees and other members of the departmental faculty have adequate opportunity to review the dissertation and participate meaningfully in the defense, the following policies apply to all Ph.D. dissertation defenses in the Department.

1. Advance Distribution of the Dissertation

A complete version of the dissertation must be made available (via Box) to the full departmental faculty (tenured and tenure-track) at least 30 calendar days before the scheduled date of the defense.

This deadline is intended to provide sufficient time for members of the dissertation committee, as well as other interested faculty, to read and evaluate the work in advance of the defense.

Accordingly, the version circulated at this time should be a substantially complete dissertation suitable for scholarly review. Minor corrections, editorial revisions, and changes arising from comments received during the review period may of course be made subsequently.

A defense should not be scheduled, or should be postponed if necessary, when the dissertation has not been made available to the departmental faculty for the required 30-day review period. Exceptions to this requirement should be granted only in extraordinary circumstances and require approval of the Graduate Committee.

The responsibility for ensuring timely distribution of the dissertation rests jointly with the student and the Ph.D. advisor.

2. **In-Person Defenses**

Ph.D. dissertation defenses are ordinarily expected to take place in person, with the candidate physically present and the committee physically present as feasible.

Remote or fully online defenses are not an alternative format to be chosen for convenience. They should be permitted only in extenuating circumstances in which an in-person defense would be impracticable or would impose a serious hardship.

A request for a remote defense must be supported by the Ph.D. advisor and approved in advance by the Graduate Committee. The request should briefly explain the circumstances that make an in-person defense impracticable.

Individual committee members may participate remotely when necessary and when permitted by University and Graduate School regulations, but the expectation remains that the defense itself will normally be an in-person departmental event.

3. **Purpose of the Policy**

These requirements are intended to preserve the academic integrity of the dissertation defense and to ensure that it functions as a thorough examination of the candidate's research rather than merely as the final procedural step toward the degree. Adequate advance circulation allows committee members and other faculty to engage seriously with the dissertation, while the presumption of an in-person defense supports substantive scholarly discussion and the broader intellectual life of the Department.

Teaching Requirements

Graduate Teaching Assistants are both graduate students and University employees with instructional responsibilities. GTAs should complete all required departmental and University training, follow the expectations stated in their appointment letters, and work closely with their course coordinator, instructor of record, or assistantship supervisor. UVA's Graduate Assistantships Policy describes the qualifications and conditions for GTA appointments and

identifies the assistantship supervisor as the person responsible for mentoring and supervising the graduate student's assistantship duties.

Departmental Orientation and Teaching Assignments

First-year graduate students typically serve as teaching assistants. They may lead discussion sections for courses such as Multivariable Calculus, Transition to Higher Mathematics, or Basic Real Analysis and may also serve as graders. First-year assignments are generally expected to require approximately 10 hours per week.

New Mathematics GTAs participate in departmental teaching orientation before classes begin. First-year students also take MATH 7000 and MATH 7010, Seminar on College Teaching and Seminar on Research in Mathematics, during the fall and spring semesters respectively, as an introduction to college-level mathematics teaching, pedagogical practices, and the professional responsibilities associated with teaching.

Students in their second year and beyond typically teach their own sections of calculus courses. These assignments generally require 15 to 20 hours per week, depending on the course and assigned responsibilities. Courses are closely coordinated by faculty members and typically use common syllabi and examinations. Graduate instructors are expected to participate in applicable orientation sessions and attend regular meetings with their course coordinators.

GTA responsibilities may include:

- Leading classes or discussion sections
- Preparing for class
- Grading assignments and assessments
- Holding scheduled office hours
- Responding appropriately to student questions
- Attending course coordination meetings
- Following common course policies and grading standards
- Completing other duties assigned by the course coordinator or instructor of record

Every student normally receives two semesters without teaching through the program's usual fellowship support. Additional support may be available through University fellowships, external fellowships, research grants, or other approved funding sources.

Students may also have opportunities to teach courses such as Financial Mathematics in later years of the program. Additional teaching experience may be available through the Directed Reading Program, Math Circles, summer REU programs, and other departmental initiatives.

Current information about teaching assignments, course coordinators, and departmental expectations is available on the Mathematics Graduate Teaching webpage.

Teaching as a Graduate Student

Teaching as a Graduate Student, commonly known as TAGS, is an orientation program offered by the UVA Center for Teaching Excellence for new teaching assistants. The program introduces inclusive and learning-centered teaching practices and addresses topics such as:

- Creating inclusive learning environments
- Principles of learning-centered teaching
- Supporting students' success
- Teaching the first day of class
- Facilitating effective classroom discussions
- Approaching feedback and grading effectively and efficiently

TAGS combines asynchronous online materials with an interactive workshop. It is primarily designed for instructors who are new to teaching, although experienced instructors may also find the materials useful.

TAGS is a supplemental University resource. Participation does not replace departmental orientation, MATH 7000, course-specific preparation, or required meetings with a course coordinator. GTAs should complete all training assigned by the Mathematics Department.

Visit the Teaching as a Graduate Student program webpage for current information.

Center for Teaching Excellence

The UVA Center for Teaching Excellence provides teaching-development programs, workshops, consultations, and on-demand resources for faculty members and graduate students. GTAs may use these resources to strengthen their skills in:

- Course and lesson planning
- Classroom facilitation
- Inclusive teaching
- Assessment design
- Grading and feedback
- Student engagement
- Reflective teaching practices
- Instructional technology

CTE resources include the UVA Teaching Hub, Learning Tech, teaching consultations, and other programs supporting effective teaching and learning. Because programs and formats may change, GTAs should consult the Center for Teaching Excellence website for current offerings.

Student Disability Access Center

The Student Disability Access Center, or SDAC, coordinates disability-related accommodations through an individualized review process. Students seeking testing accommodations, including extended time, must complete the SDAC accommodation process.

Instructors are responsible for following approved accommodation notices and working with SDAC when necessary to implement accommodations appropriately. Students with approved testing-related accommodations may be eligible to use the Center for Accommodated Testing.

GTAs should:

- Follow the approved accommodation notice provided for a student
- Preserve the student's privacy
- Avoid requesting unnecessary medical information
- Consult the course coordinator or instructor of record when implementation is unclear
- Contact SDAC when additional guidance is needed

GTAs should not independently determine whether a student qualifies for a disability-related accommodation or modify essential course requirements without consulting the course coordinator or instructor of record.

A temporary illness or injury does not always follow the same process as an established disability-related accommodation. SDAC may assist when a temporary medical condition is sufficiently severe and of significant duration. Depending on the circumstances, a student may need to communicate with the instructor, an academic dean, a healthcare provider, Care and Support Services, SDAC, or another appropriate University office.

Visit the Student Disability Access Center website for current accommodation information and faculty guidance.

Religious Accommodations

Students seeking academic accommodation for a sincerely held religious belief, practice, or observance should submit a written request directly to the course instructor.

UVA expects instructors to make reasonable efforts to accommodate students so they do not experience adverse academic consequences when religious observances conflict with academic requirements. An accommodation is not required if it would cause an undue hardship or fundamentally alter an essential element of the course, program, or activity.

A GTA who receives a religious accommodation request should promptly consult the course coordinator or instructor of record before finalizing course-specific arrangements. Students and instructors may contact the Office for Equal Opportunity and Civil Rights with questions about the applicable policy or process.

Visit the Student Religious Accommodations webpage for current guidance.

Accessible Course Materials and Learning Technology

GTAs should make course materials accessible and use University-supported instructional technologies in accordance with departmental and course expectations.

SDAC faculty resources may include:

- Canvas accessibility guidance
- Suggested syllabus language
- Communication templates
- Accommodation guidance
- Information about accessible and alternative-format materials

When a student has an approved need for course materials in an alternative format, SDAC may obtain or create those materials and may contact the instructor for access to course content. Instructors are encouraged to identify textbooks and other required materials as early as possible when alternative formats may be needed.

The UVA Teaching Hub, Learning Tech, SDAC, and the Center for Teaching Excellence provide additional guidance about accessible course design and instructional technology.

Departmental Teaching Materials

Teaching materials from previous semesters may be available through UVACanvas or another department-managed location. These materials may include previous examinations, lesson plans, course documents, and teaching guidance.

GTAs should contact the current course coordinator or instructor of record to determine:

- What materials are available
- Where the materials are maintained
- How access may be requested
- Whether materials from previous semesters may be reused or adapted

GTAs must follow current course requirements even when using materials from previous semesters.

Additional Professional Development

PhD Plus is a University-wide professional-development initiative for graduate students and postdoctoral scholars. Its offerings may include courses, workshops, panel discussions, skills programs, career fairs, internships, individual career advising, and selected programs related to college teaching and academic careers.

PhD Plus is a broad professional-development resource and does not replace required departmental teaching preparation. GTAs may consult the PhD Plus website for current opportunities.

Questions and Escalation

GTAs should contact the course coordinator or instructor of record when they have questions or concerns involving:

- Course content or learning objectives
- Grading standards or grade disputes
- Extensions or make-up work

- Missed classes or assessments
- Approved disability accommodations
- Religious accommodation requests
- Student conduct or classroom disruptions
- Student well-being or a situation requiring referral
- A student's significant health-related concern
- The GTA's assigned responsibilities
- GTA workload or time expectations
- A possible conflict between departmental and course policies

GTAs should not attempt to resolve a significant accommodation, health, conduct, academic-integrity, or student-support matter independently. They should preserve the student's privacy, document necessary course-related communications, and promptly involve the instructor of record, course coordinator, assistantship supervisor, or appropriate University office.